

BRENDAN PALKOWSKI

Grand Rapids, MI

palko.dev | github.com/bpalko | linkedin.com/in/brendan-palkowski

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Core: Go, Kubernetes (operators, CRDs, Kubebuilder), Terraform, Helm, Crossplane, ArgoCD, AWS/GCP

Infrastructure: Docker, GitLab CI/CD, GitHub Actions, Postgres, Python, Istio, External Secrets

Agentic: Cursor (self-hosted agents), Claude Code

EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer

Jan. 2024 – Present

First American

Remote

- Removed Aurora provisioning from the PR critical path with a Go Kubernetes operator that makes each preview an isolated database tenant of the shared dev cluster, from creation through teardown.
- Built a Go operator that reconciles RDS-managed Aurora credentials from AWS Secrets Manager into Crossplane-managed Kubernetes resources, preventing drift through rotation and disaster recovery.
- Built a policy-driven operator that provisions and reconciles the Kubernetes compliance resources each application needs in labeled customer namespaces, correcting drift for the life of the tenant.
- Adopted Crossplane as the infrastructure API: custom resources and Helm packages for Aurora RDS/DocDB, S3, Redis, and IAM (Pod Identity), consumed by ~400 application tenants.
- Drove the transformation of AWS and GCP infrastructure into a shared Terraform platform, giving teams a consistent, scalable deployment model.
- Rolled out ArgoCD and Kargo as the Golden Path, moving releases from multi-month cycles to per-commit delivery. Every tenant depends on a Helm chart we maintain that abstracts platform features onto Kubernetes, including the Istio mesh, External Secrets, ingress via Tyk, and autoscaling.
- Technical Pod Lead across multiple platform initiatives, accountable for teams of 3–8 while remaining hands-on in architecture and implementation; platform on-call.

Cloud Engineer

Mar. 2022 – Jan. 2024

Alteryx

Remote

- Rebuilt the multi-cloud Terraform platform (GCP and AWS) across four accounts plus customer data planes, cutting environment builds from weeks to under 3 hours.
- Wrote Go services for split-plane cluster lifecycle, Terraform templating, and GitLab mirroring.
- Led AI data-plane infrastructure in Terraform; onboarded teams onto Kubernetes, ArgoCD, and Helm.

Predictive Modeler

June 2020 – Mar. 2022

Auto-Owners Insurance

Lansing, MI

- Built and ran 70+ production scrapers with Kafka and cron, used by underwriters for risk analysis.
- Migrated the department to Konvoy Kubernetes (production and non-production) and trained modelers.

EDUCATION

University of Michigan

Ann Arbor, MI

Bachelor of Science in Information Science

VOLUNTEER

Coding Instructor, [PiAcademy](https://PiAcademy.org)

Grand Rapids, MI

- Teach coding fundamentals through Raspberry Pi projects at a local youth tech nonprofit.